

Case Study Report

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Section A — Establish the Context

In the today's academic and professional environment, almost every student interacting with digital tool but most of them are just operating the tool, they cannot explain why they are using the tool, How the tool is working efficiently and most important why using this particular tool not others. These things showing awareness about digital world. Arjun uploaded code on GitHub but did not realize that incomplete commits remain permanently visible.

I used Canva in my task because I know how to use Canva efficiently and also Canva tool known for making design effortlessly. Some of the students often apply templates without considering copyright of communication clarity. Tools like Canva, Prezi, and others are designed to make everything look professional, even when the thinking behind it is shallow.

Digital participations mean simply being presence on platform like LinkedIn, GitHub, Kaggle, etc. These platform very useful to showing your active participation or we can say how you actively working in your field. This is also helping us to establish networks through various persons who already and top position of your field.

Sometimes, around me, I see several batchmates are just copying code from GitHub without reading and understand it. Digital literacy means not just operating the tool, whichever available, it means how much you understand and the consequences and aware about digital tools. Sometimes, I also notice student listing their skills that they barely know about it. These practices are not failure of ability but also these things showing failure of reflection. Students are capable of using the tools, but they rarely stop to ask: What does this mean? What impression does this create? What risks am I taking?

Students are rarely stop to ask what impression their actions create or what risks they are taking. The digital world does not forget or remove any action or activity performed on internet. The distinction matters because the digital world does not forget. Everything uploaded by you today remains visible tomorrow in the form of your digital footprints. The real problem is not what student cannot do in actual, what they do not think about their circumstances and their effects.

Section B — Digital Identity and Ethics

Digital platform has transformed how students present themselves to the world. Tools like LinkedIn, GitHub, Canva, and other professional tools give equal opportunity to everyone to perform or showcase your skills. It would not matter if someone from which tier college or someone form city or village everyone

can show their skill and achievements through these platforms. Yet this promise only holds if platforms are used honestly and actively.

The current culture pushes students toward performance over reality, and that things create long term risks. A polished profile may look impressive, but if it is built on exaggeration or shallow participation, it becomes a liability rather than an asset. I telling you story of a student , Previously he don't have profile on GitHub due to demand on some project he or some club recruitment regarding he made a profile on GitHub and showing his work he is copying repository files from others profile in interview, interviewer asked from their repository how he made which tools you used and How you think about this project , from where to get idea to make this project. Because of he just copied from another he not able to give answer of this question. In this case project enhanced his profile but overall, it became liability for his carrier. So always be aware what kind of project are you entering in your

profile what it will giving impact on you profile in future.

Equal Opportunity – But Unequal Guidance

If you see from above, it completely looking like everyone getting equal opportunity and platform completely visible democratic. But in actual a student from a small-town college can build a LinkedIn profile and be noticed by recruiters just as easily as someone from a top-tier institution. Also, GitHub allows anyone to share project, and Canva enables professional looks design without expensive software.

However, in actual, the student form getting more benefits form this only those who are knowing this completely or those who have already guidance about this. Seniors, mentors, or faculty often show how to use these platforms strategically. A first time student without such support may create a weak profile

and not even realize it looks weak. This opportunity is not equal for everyone, but the outcomes are not.

Performance Over Authenticity

The culture of digital platforms rewards more appearance than substance. If we taking LinkedIn as example, values of a polished profile over an honest one. Students add skills after watching a single YouTube tutorial. This is not outright lying, but it is not honest either. The pressure comes from seeing peers with impressive profiles and feeling left behind. Arjun's case illustrates this clearly that he listed skills he had barely explored, and everyone around him knew this was common practice. The platform helped him rewards the illusion of competence, but it would not give the reality of learning.

Misrepresentation and Ethics

Here, the ethical line must be drawn clearly. Exaggerating skills is wrong, even if it is widespread. The damage does not appear immediately but the surfaces later — in interviews, internships, or jobs where students cannot back up their claims there it gives hard impacts. Recruiters lose trust, and genuine students suffer because inflated profiles devalue the credibility of the platform also. Misrepresentation is not a harmless shortcut only it undermines both individual integrity and collective reputation.

Digital Permanence

Perhaps the most underrated aspect of digital identity is permanence. Students often treat GitHub or LinkedIn like WhatsApp statuses that disappear after a day. In reality, everything

stays. A recruiter in 2028 can scroll back and see a student's first GitHub commit from 2024. Early mistakes, incomplete projects, or exaggerated claims remain visible. Should students be held accountable for these early missteps? Yes, but institutions also share responsibility. Awareness of digital permanence should be taught from day one, not after damage has already been done.

Personal Observation

Around me, I see batchmates copying GitHub code without understanding it, then showcasing it as their own. I see LinkedIn profiles filled with skills that students cannot apply in practice. These are not failures of ability but also, they are failures of honesty and reflection. The platforms themselves encourage performance, but students must resist the

temptation to exaggerate. Digital identity is not just about visibility in actual or we can say in real it is about credibility.

” Digital platforms benefit students, but only if used honestly. When performance overshadows reality, the risks are long-term and unavoidable”

Section C — Collaboration vs Misuse

Digital platforms have changed the way of working among students. Nowadays, Tools like Google Docs, GitHub, and shared drives allow real-time collaboration that was impossible in a purely physical setting. A group can edit the same document simultaneously, other member of that group track version history, while other learn from each other's changes. These features mirror what actual workplaces use, making early exposure valuable. Students who learn to collaborate digitally are preparing themselves for the teamwork, communication, and project management that how define professional environments.

How Platforms Help

Google Docs is the clearest example of genuine collaboration. Real-time editing means ideas can be exchanged instantly, and version history

allows students to see who contributed what. This transparency can help students learn not only the final answer but also the process of reaching it. Similarly, GitHub's branching and merging features teach students how to manage code collectively, just as software teams do in industry. These tools are not shortcuts; they are training grounds for professional skills.

How Platforms Enable Avoidance

Yet the same tools can also enable avoidance. When everyone edits one shared document, individual effort becomes invisible. The student who contributes the least still receives the same marks as the one who contributes the most. Arjun's group project illustrates this perfectly that how the final output looked polished, but the effort was unequal and the understanding uneven. The platform made it easy to divide tasks so much that some students learned very little. Collaboration became a way to hide behind collective output.

Where Is the Boundary?

The boundary between collaboration and misuse is blurry. Collaboration means working together toward shared understanding. While Misuse means dividing labor so much that individual learning disappears. Most students never stop to think about this distinction. They see the polished output and assume the process was successful, even if half the group did not truly engage. The danger is that platforms make misuse look identical to collaboration from the outside.

The Strongest Argument for Collaboration

Despite these risks, the strongest argument for collaboration remains valid for real-world work it is always collaborative. Solo projects are rare in the industry. Group assignments teach

teamwork, communication, and the ability to handle unequal effort all are in real skills that students will need later. Learning to manage frustration when a teammate contributes less, or to coordinate across different schedules, is part of professional growth. In this sense, collaboration is not just about the final product but also this shows about learning how to work with people.

My Position

Collaboration is valuable, but only when accountability is built in. Without accountability, the tool becomes a shortcut machine, rewarding minimal effort and shallow understanding. With accountability most of the platforms, like Google Docs and GitHub become powerful learning environments. The challenge for educators and institutions is to design assignments that encourage collaboration while ensuring that individual learning is not lost in the process. Collaboration

is essential for preparing students for real-world teamwork, but without accountability, digital tools risk becoming vehicles of misuse rather than learning.

Section D — Cyber Awareness and Responsibility

Phishing is one of those problems that everyone has heard about, yet it still works. The reason is simple: in theory, people know what phishing is, but in the real moment, urgency overrides knowledge. Arjun knew about phishing. He had read about it. Still, when he got a message that looked urgent, he clicked. That is the key point emotion beats information. Fear of missing an opportunity, excitement about being selected, or pressure of a deadline can shut down careful thinking in seconds.

Who is Responsible — User or Platform?

Responsibility is shared. The user has to slow down, check the sender, and verify before acting. But platforms also have a duty. They should build stronger warnings, flag suspicious addresses, and avoid designs that reward speed over caution. Right now, most platforms put 100% of the responsibility on the user, which is unfair. If the system knows a message looks suspicious, it should help the user pause before making a mistake.

Negligence, Lack of Education, or Systemic Failure?

It is not just one factor — it is all three together. Calling it pure negligence is harsh, because Arjun had knowledge but not the habit of applying it. Calling it pure systemic failure is also wrong, because individuals must take responsibility for their actions. The most accurate answer is this: awareness programs

teach facts, but they do not build habits. That is the real failure. Knowing something in theory is not enough; practice is what makes awareness effective.

Are Current Measures Enough?

Clearly not. Password rules and awareness posters have existed for years, yet scams are increasing, not decreasing. The missing piece is behavioural training. Students need practice in reacting to real situations, not just reading about them. Simulations, drills, or interactive exercises would help build habits that resist urgency and emotion.

Personal Example

I have seen UPI scam calls targeting students. The caller pretends to be from a bank or a payment app, and the trick is always urgency. “Your account will be blocked in 10 minutes,” or “You must confirm now to get the refund.” Even when students know about scams, the urgency makes them act without thinking.

This shows how phishing and fraud succeed not because people are unaware, but because they are caught in the wrong emotional moment. Cyber awareness is not just about knowing the facts. It is about building habits that resist urgency, and both users and platforms must share responsibility for that.

Section E — Communication and Etiquette

Students today are not unaware of email rules. Most of us have been taught at some point how to write a proper email. The real problem is habit. WhatsApp and Instagram have trained us to communicate in short, fast, and casual bursts. That habit does not switch off automatically when we move to email or professional platforms.

Arjun’s email to his professor — “send asap” — is something almost every student has done or seen. It is not rudeness in intention; it is

simply the casual habit bleeding into the wrong context. The problem is not that students do not know the format of a formal email. The problem is that they cannot switch registers when the situation demands it.

Informal communication is becoming normal even in professional spaces. Slack messages, startup culture, and even some professors prefer a casual tone. But the risk is clear: students who cannot adjust their style when needed will be judged negatively.

The skill, therefore, is not just knowing how to write a formal email. The real skill is knowing when to use which style. Switching between casual and formal communication depending on context is what shows maturity and professionalism.

” Communication etiquette is not about memorizing formats. It is about awareness of context and the ability to adapt tone accordingly.”

Section F — Personal Reflection

Before doing this case study, I thought digital literacy only meant knowing how to use apps and the internet. For me, it was just about being able to operate tools like LinkedIn, GitHub, or Canva. After going through Arjun's story, I realized it is much more than that. Digital literacy is about awareness and understanding the consequences of what we do online and how those actions stay with us.

Some parts of Arjun's story felt very familiar. I have seen batchmates copying code from GitHub without really understanding it. I have also noticed LinkedIn profiles where students list skills they barely know. Honestly, even my own profiles are not 100% accurate. Sometimes I add skills that I have only touched once or twice, just because I feel pressure when I see others showing off impressive profiles.

The phishing section also made me think. I remember once I almost clicked on a suspicious link that promised a quick reward. I stopped at the last moment, but I realized how easy it is to fall for urgency. It is not about knowledge — it is about the habit of slowing down and checking carefully.

If I have to change one habit, it will be this: I will stop exaggerating my skills online. Instead, I will only list what I can actually do. It may look less polished, but it will be honest. And I will also make it a habit to pause before clicking on any link that looks urgent or too good to be true. These are small changes, but they feel real to me.